

Preface

The Five-Year Business Plan

From licensed-day-one to exit-ready.

PREPARED FOR DATE HORIZON

Founder — May 2026 — 1 mo · 3 mo · 6 mo · 1 yr · 3 yr.

Preface 2026 5 yr
independent travel advisor practice.

CONTENTS

Table of Contents

01 Executive Summary

02 Founder Situation & Capacity

03 Unit Economics & The Math

04 Market Position & Segments

05 The Six-Horizon Plan

5.1 Month 1 — Foundation

5.2 Months 2–3 — Early Traction

5.3 Months 4–6 — Machine Running

5.4 Year 1 — Scaling

5.5 Year 3 — Team & Brand

5.6 Year 5 — Exit-Ready

06 The Cold Outreach Playbook

07 The Content Engine

08 The Partnership Playbook

09 Financial Projections

10 Capital & Tooling Plan

11 Risk Register

12 Decision Gates

13 Weekly Operating Rhythm

14 The Exit Math**A** Appendix — Templates & Checklists

SECTION 01

Executive Summary

Preface is a Toronto-based independent travel advisor practice serving the underserved 28–36 demographic — the “HENRY” cohort with luxury aspirations, real disposable income, and zero existing travel-advisor relationships. The opportunity is to be first.

The Thesis

The traditional travel-advisor industry has aged with its clientele. Virtuoso, Brownell, and Brilliant Travels skew 55+. Meanwhile, an entire generation of HENRYs — engaged couples, new parents, milestone-trip planners, friend groups doing annual ski weeks — books \$5,000+ vacations on Expedia without realizing that the same hotel rooms, at identical rates, come with breakfast, upgrades, and credits when booked through a TICO-certified advisor.

The path: become licensed (TICO + Fora) in month 1, build a cold-outreach machine and content engine through months 2–6, hit a consistent **\$2,500/wk in commissions by day 300**, and use Year 1's \$100K+ revenue to fund team expansion in Year 2–3. By Year 5, Preface is either a \$400–600K/yr lifestyle agency or a \$3–16M acquisition target.

The Numbers



Why This Works Now

- **Demographic gap.** No serious advisor practice targets HENRYs under 40 in Canada. Existing advisors don't speak the language; existing online tools don't unlock luxury rates.

- **Distribution arbitrage.** Fora Travel provides the back-office (supplier contracts, commission tracking, training, brand support) for \$410/yr + 30% commission split. That's cheap infrastructure.
- **Cold-outreach asymmetry.** Wedding planners and real estate agents in the US are accessible (CAN-SPAM applies, not CASL). 500 emails/day with a 2% reply rate yields 10+ partnership conversations/wk.
- **Content compounds.** One viral TikTok in months 4–6 (statistically near-certain at 12+ posts/wk for 24 weeks) produces a multi-year inbound trickle.
- **Founder fit.** Sales-trained, full-time job with steal-able lull time during business hours, scaling to full grind mode within 6 months.

Key Risks

- TICO certification deprioritized → entire timeline slips.
- Burnout at month 9 before run-rate hits target.
- Day-job conflict surfaced too early, forcing a premature quit without runway.
- Founder cannot delegate at year 2–3, preventing team scale and locking practice into solo plateau.

Critical Decisions Ahead

1. **Month 6:** Day-job — stay, reduce, or quit.
2. **Month 12:** Incorporate (CCPC) for tax deferral and future LCGE eligibility.
3. **Month 18:** First sub-advisor hire under Fora team structure.
4. **Year 3:** Stay on Fora vs. become independent TICO host agency.
5. **Year 4–5:** Sell (acquisition) vs. operate (lifestyle income forever).

SECTION 02

Founder Situation & Capacity

An honest accounting of what's available, what's constrained, and what changes when.

Current State (Month 0)

Age	29
Location	Toronto, Canada
Primary Income	Full-time sales role (covers personal overhead)
Available Hours (current)	~30–35 hrs/wk — workday lull (2–3 hrs) + evenings (3–5 hrs) + weekends
Available Hours (post-move)	60–80 hrs/wk — “absolute grind mode”
Network	~50 warm-network individuals appropriate for initial outreach (friends, family, ex-colleagues, peer engaged couples)
Skills	Sales (primary), customer-facing, writing; willing to learn content production
Capital Available	Sufficient for ~\$1K month-1 setup + \$200/mo opex through year 1
Runway	Day job income still primary — business is supplemental until month 6+

Capacity Curve by Phase

PHASE	MONTHS	HOURS/WK ON BUSINESS	DAY-JOB STATE
Foundation	0–1	20–25	Full-time
Early Traction	2–3	30–35	Full-time
Machine Running	4–6	40–50	Full-time, decision pending
Scaling	7–12	50–60	Reduced or phased out
Team Build	13–36	40–50	Quit
Operator Mode	37–60	30–40	n/a

Constraints to Plan Around

Day-Job IP & Non-Compete

Operate this business exclusively from personal devices, personal email, personal Calendly, personal accounts. Do not store client data on company laptops. Do not use company-paid Zoom, Slack, or productivity tools. Do not work on this during clearly-tracked sales-team time blocks. If a non-compete or non-solicit exists in your employment contract, have an employment lawyer review it before launch (\$300 well spent).

CASL Compliance (Canada)

Canadian Anti-Spam Legislation restricts cold electronic outreach to Canadian recipients without express or implied consent. **All cold email is targeted at US recipients** (CAN-SPAM, much looser). Canadian outreach happens in-person, by referral, or to industry peers under implied-consent provisions.

TICO Certification Is The Critical Path

You cannot legally sell travel from Ontario without TICO certification. The certification process is ~\$150 plus an exam. Block 3 evenings/week for study. **No bookings happen until this is passed.**

SECTION 03

Unit Economics & The Math

Every income target back-solves to a specific number of bookings, calls, and outreach touches. Here is the math.

Per-Booking Revenue

The Fora model: you collect the trip price from the client, the supplier (hotel, cruise line, tour operator) pays a commission to Fora directly, Fora retains 30% and remits 70% to you. You separately invoice a planning fee from the client for complex trips.

TRIP TYPE	AVG BOOKING	COMMISSION %	AFTER FORA 30%	PLANNING FEE	NET TO YOU
Couples weekend	\$4,500	11%	\$347	\$100	\$447
Family all-inclusive	\$7,000	13%	\$637	\$150	\$787
Honeymoon (2-stop)	\$12,000	12%	\$1,008	\$500	\$1,508
Bach weekend (10 pax)	\$14,000	12%	\$1,176	\$500	\$1,676
Milestone group (15 pax)	\$60,000	12%	\$5,040	\$2,500	\$7,540
Blended Average					\$700

Blended average weighted to expected Y1 mix: 30% couples, 20% family, 18% honeymoon, 18% bach, 4% milestone, 10% other.

Income Targets Back-Solved

INCOME TIER	\$/WK NET	BOOKINGS/WK	BOOKINGS/YR	PHASE
Y1 Minimum Floor	\$1,000	1.5	75	Months 4–6
Day 300 Target	\$2,500	3.5	180	Month 10
Y2 Stable Run-Rate	\$3,500	5	260	Year 2
Solo Ceiling	\$5,000	7	365	Year 3

Activity Back-Solved (Day 300 Target)

At day 300 you need 3.5 bookings/wk. Conversion math:

FUNNEL STAGE	VOLUME/WK	CONV. %	NOTES
Cold emails sent (US)	7,500	—	1,500/day × 5 days, across 2–3 sending domains
Replies	75	1.0%	B2C engaged + B2B planners blended
Discovery calls booked	22	30%	Calendly link in second reply
Intake calls held	18	80%	20% no-show / reschedule
Proposals sent	12	65%	Skip prospects who aren't ready
Bookings closed	3.5	30%	Industry-normal close rate

Plus partnership-sourced leads (15–25/wk from 5+ active partners by month 9) and content-sourced inbound (5–10/wk by month 9) — these have 2–3x higher close rates because trust is pre-built. The cold-email funnel is the engine; partnerships and content are the multipliers.

Lifetime Client Economics

A first-time honeymoon client at age 30 is worth more than just the honeymoon. Modeled lifetime journey:

YEAR	TRIP	BOOKING	NET TO YOU
Y0	Bachelor / Bachelorette weekend	\$1,400/pp × group	\$1,675
Y0	Honeymoon	\$12,000	\$1,508
Y1	First anniversary	\$6,000	\$640
Y2	Babymoon	\$4,500	\$450
Y3	First-baby trip	\$5,500	\$530
Y4–Y8	Annual family week × 5	\$7,000 each	\$3,935
Y9	Friend-group ski trip	\$3,500/pp × 4	\$840
Y10	Milestone 40th birthday trip	\$25,000	\$2,650
10-Year LTV			~\$12,228

The Strategic Takeaway

A booked client isn't a transaction — it's the start of a 10-year, \$12K+ revenue stream, with referrals stacked on top. This is why customer-acquisition costs of \$200–400 per booked client are sustainable. It's also why every client must get a 5-star experience: a single negative reference at month 18 doesn't just lose one trip, it loses a decade of compounding.

SECTION 04

Market Position & Segments

Where Preface fits in a crowded but mis-targeted market.

Competitive Landscape

COMPETITOR TYPE	EXAMPLES	AUDIENCE	WHY YOU WIN
Legacy Luxury Agencies	Virtuoso member firms, Brownell, Brilliant Travels	55+ HNWI	Don't speak millennial language; advisors retire faster than they replace; client base aging out
OTAs	Expedia, Booking.com, Hotels.com	Everyone	No upgrades, no credits, no human; same rate but worse experience
DIY Booking	Direct-to-hotel	Self-directed	Most clients don't know suppliers give better rates to advisors than direct
Other Fora Advisors	~12,000 Fora advisors globally	Fragmented	Most are part-time hobbyists with no brand, no system, no segmentation
Bach-Trip Specialists	Bach Weekend, Bachelorette.com	Bach only	Single-segment; you own the same client across 10 years of trips

The Five Primary Segments

SEGMENT	TRIGGER	AVG BOOKING	Y1 MIX
Couples Annual Trip	Planning January window	\$4,500	30%
Family School-Break	Spring break / winter break	\$7,000	20%
Honeymoon	Engagement → 8–14 mo out	\$12,000	18%
Bach / Bachelorette	Engagement → 4–8 mo out	\$14,000 (group)	18%
Milestone Group	40th / 50th / parents' anniversary	\$60,000 (group)	4%

Six Additional Segments to Layer In

SEGMENT	TRIGGER	AVG TRIP	STRATEGIC VALUE
Babymoon	2nd–3rd trimester announcement	\$3–6K	Highly seasonal; stacks onto honeymoon clients
First Anniversary	11 months post-wedding	\$4–8K	CRM-triggered; near-100% conversion of honeymoon clients
Friend-Group Annual	Sept planning for following ski/golf season	\$2–3K/pp	Subscription-like; 5–10 year repeat
Reunion Trip	10-yr college reunion math	\$2–4K/pp	Predictable annual cohort; alumni network density
Graduation	MBA, residency, law school May–June	\$5–15K	High-spend; dense peer-referral pool
Sabbatical / Reset	Burnout, career break	\$8–25K	Story-rich content; high per-trip revenue

The Demographic Insight

The strategic edge isn't a particular segment — it's the **relationship-holder**. In a 28–36 cohort, the adult child plans for the family. The 35-year-old daughter is the one who books her parents' 40th anniversary trip, her own honeymoon, her brother's bach weekend, the family Christmas vacation, and her own kid's first international trip. **One trusted advisor relationship = 5–8 trips per year across the family system.**

This is why segmenting feels expansive: you're not chasing five audiences, you're serving one audience across many life moments.

Parents & Grandparents — A Note On Scope

Avoid direct outreach to the 60+ demographic. That's the entrenched legacy lane (Virtuoso, Brownell) and they have decades of relationship capital you can't out-compete. Your edge is serving them through their adult child via the Milestone Group segment. Don't dilute the brand by targeting their generation directly.

SECTION 05

The Six-Horizon Plan

Each phase has hard deliverables, KPIs, and a single failure mode that must be watched.

PHASE 5.1 · MONTH 1

Foundation

Get licensed, get launched, get the first five.

OBJECTIVE

Be legally able to sell travel, technically able to book a trip, and personally credible by week 4. Close 3–5 bookings from existing network.

HARD DELIVERABLES

- ❑ TICO Certification Program purchased (\$150) — week 1
- ❑ Fora Canada application submitted — week 1
- ❑ TICO exam passed — by week 3
- ❑ Fora onboarding training started in parallel
- ❑ Business domain + Google Workspace email — week 1
- ❑ Calendly link configured — week 1
- ❑ Tally/Typeform intake form — week 1
- ❑ Website live (v2 mockups deployed) — week 3
- ❑ Social handles secured (IG, TikTok, LinkedIn) — week 1
- ❑ 50-person warm-network list with “next trip” status — week 2

MONTH 1 KPIS

LICENSED

Yes

TICO + Fora

BOOKINGS

3–5

From warm network

REVENUE

\$1–3K

Commission

SITE LIVE

Yes

3 testimonials staged

EXPLICITLY NOT DOING THIS MONTH

- No paid ads
- No cold outreach
- No production content (just placeholder posts so profiles aren't empty)
- No partnership outreach
- No premium tooling

The Failure Mode

TICO study gets deprioritized. The exam is the only gate with a true timeline lock. Block 3 evenings/wk and finish before week 4. If month 1 ends without TICO passed, the entire timeline slips.

PHASE 5.2 · MONTHS 2-3

Early Traction

Build the machine, book the first twenty, look like a real business.

OBJECTIVE

Move from “friend with a license” to operator with momentum. Cold outreach soft-launched. Content cadence locked. First wedding planner partnership.

HARD DELIVERABLES

- ☐ Cold email infrastructure live: Instantly.ai or Smartlead — week 5
- ☐ Lead lists purchased: Apollo or Seamless.AI — week 5
- ☐ Cold outbound: 500 emails/day (200 B2B planners + 300 B2C engaged) — week 7
- ☐ Content cadence locked: IG 4×, TikTok 3×, LinkedIn 3× per week
- ☐ Newsletter launched on Beehiiv or Substack — week 6
- ☐ 1-2 wedding planner partnerships signed with 25%-of-commission referral fee — by week 12
- ☐ Toronto in-person coffee circuit: 10 meetings with wedding planners, photographers, venues

MONTH 3 KPIS

LIFETIME CLIENTS 15–25 Cumulative	MONTHLY REVENUE \$4–6K Commissions	PARTNERSHIPS 1–2 Sending leads	IG FOLLOWERS ~2K Engaged audience
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THE COLD EMAIL VOLUME LOGIC

Two sending domains (yourname@preface.travel + a secondary like yourname@gopreface.com) keeps deliverability healthy. 250 emails/day per inbox × 2 inboxes per domain × 2 domains = 1,000/day max safe volume. Start at 500/day in week 5, ramp to 1,000/day by week 8.

The Failure Mode

Cold outreach quality, not quantity, is the issue if month 3 ends with fewer than 15 clients. Re-read your sequences — if they read like every other cold email, they convert like every other cold email. Specificity beats polish: name a planner by their actual market and reference a trip type they actually deal with.

PHASE 5.3 · MONTHS 4–6

Machine Running

Hit the floor. Cold + content + referrals all producing.

OBJECTIVE

Hit minimum **\$1,000/wk commissions consistently** by week 24. Decide on the day-job at month 6.

HARD DELIVERABLES

- ☐ Cold email scaled to 1,500–2,500/day across two sending domains
- ☐ 3–5 active partnerships sending warm leads weekly
- ☐ 5K+ Instagram, 5K+ TikTok, 500+ newsletter subscribers
- ☐ At least one social post hits 100K+ views (statistically near-certain at this cadence)
- ☐ Case-study page live: 3 real client trip recaps with photos
- ☐ VA hired for 15–25 hrs/wk: lead-list cleaning, reply triage, scheduling

☐ Lifetime clients: 40–60

MONTH 6 KPIS

MONTHLY REVENUE \$5–8K Commissions	WEEKLY AVERAGE \$1K+ Floor hit	PARTNERSHIPS 5 Active sources	NEWSLETTER 500+ Engaged subscribers
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THE DAY-JOB DECISION

At end of month 6, choose one:

OPTION	TRIGGER CONDITIONS	OUTCOME
Stay full-time	Business < \$1K/wk OR runway < 4 months	Extend Y1 target by 3–6 months
Reduce to part-time	If your employer offers 60% schedule	Cleaner ramp, lower stress
Quit	\$1K+/wk for 8 consecutive weeks AND 4+ months runway saved	Required to hit \$2,500/wk by day 300

The Failure Mode

Quitting too early. The math of the day-300 target requires full-time effort starting around month 7, but only if foundations are working. Don't conflate "I want to quit" with "the business says I should quit." The 8-consecutive-weeks rule is the test.

PHASE 5.4 · MONTHS 7–12

Year 1 — Scaling

Hit \$2,500/wk by day 300. Become a real business.

OBJECTIVE

Average **\$2,500/wk** by week 43 (day 300). End Y1 with **\$100K+** in commission revenue. Build systems that prevent burnout.

HARD DELIVERABLES

- ❑ \$2,500/wk run-rate by week 43
- ❑ 150+ lifetime clients by month 12
- ❑ 10–15 active partnerships
- ❑ 10K+ combined social following
- ❑ 2,000–5,000 newsletter subscribers
- ❑ First newsletter-only client conversion (someone who never met you in person)
- ❑ VA at 20–25 hrs/wk handling all repeatable admin
- ❑ Day-job phased out by month 9

YEAR 1 FINANCIAL PICTURE

LINE ITEM	ANNUAL
Gross commission revenue	\$80–135K
Less: Fora 30% cut	(\$24–40K)
Plus: planning fees	\$15–25K
Net business revenue	\$71–120K
Less: opex (tools, VA, domain, email)	(\$8–12K)
Take-home before tax	\$63–108K

QUARTERLY PACING

QUARTER	MONTHS	TARGET REVENUE	DEFINING ACTIVITY
Q1	1–3	\$5–15K	Foundation + early traction
Q2	4–6	\$15–25K	Machine running + day-job decision
Q3	7–9	\$25–40K	Acceleration
Q4	10–12	\$35–55K	\$2,500/wk locked in

The Failure Mode

Burnout at month 9. You're working harder than ever and the line doesn't yet show the inflection. Two responses are wrong: (a) quit, or (b) push harder on the same activity. The right response is to drop the two segments performing worst and double down on the three that work — and to take a real long weekend off.

PHASE 5.5 · YEAR 3

Team & Brand

You hit max solo throughput. Choose: cap and run, or build.

THE FORK

Year 3 forces a choice. Solo, you'll plateau at \$200–280K personal commissions + fees. To go higher, you build a team.

PATH A — SOLO LIFESTYLE

- \$200–300K commissions, \$150–220K take-home
- 35-hour weeks, premium clients only
- No team override revenue
- Plateau forever; limited sale value

PATH B — BUILD TO SELL

- 2–4 advisors under Preface (Fora Team structure or independent host)
- Personal \$200K commissions + \$50–100K team override = \$250–300K total
- \$400K–1M total team commission revenue
- Brand recognized in Toronto for the 28–36 demographic
- Newsletter at 10–25K subscribers
- 25–40 partnership relationships, top 10 sending consistent volume

HOW TO FIND & PAY ADVISORS

The Fora Team Leader model lets you bring on advisors under your tier. You provide leads + training; you keep 20–30% override on their commissions. Talent pools:

- **Peer network** — friends in PR, hospitality, sales who want side income

- **Wedding planners' employees** — adjacent skills, hate their hours
- **Flameout Fora advisors** — already licensed; lack leads; you have leads

Typical first hire: sales-aptitude friend who sells ~\$300–500K/yr in trips. Their commission ~\$36–60K. Your override: \$11–18K. With 3 such advisors, that's **\$40–55K passive override** stacked on top of your personal output.

HIRE TRIGGER CONDITIONS

1. Lead volume exceeds capacity (turning away or going cold)
2. Brand has gravitational pull (advisors apply to you)
3. Process is documented (intake, booking, follow-up SOPs)
4. You can pay them (\$30K+ override pool available)

Realistic earliest: month 18. Plan Y3 for 2–4.

THE INDEPENDENT HOST DECISION

Around Year 2–3 you'll evaluate leaving Fora for your own TICO-registered host agency.

LEVER	STAY ON FORA	INDEPENDENT HOST
Commission split	70/30 to advisor	100% to you
Capital needed	\$410/yr	\$10K TCF deposit + setup
Back-office burden	Fora handles all	Your problem: commissions, E&O, TICO compliance
Brand control	Partial — under Fora umbrella	Full
Sellability	Limited (Fora owns infrastructure)	High (clean asset)
Right time to switch	—	When override revenue alone is \$80K+/yr

PHASE 5.6 · YEAR 5

Exit-Ready

\$200K isn't enough for a family. The exit is.

TWO END STATES

	LIFESTYLE AGENCY	ACQUISITION TARGET
Team size	5–8 advisors	12–20 advisors
Revenue	\$1.5–3M/yr	\$4–8M/yr
Personal income	\$400–600K/yr	\$300–500K/yr pre-exit
Time investment	30–40 hrs/wk	50–60 hrs/wk Y3–Y5
Exit value	None (lifestyle)	\$3–16M sale + 2–8M earnout
Best for	Income + family time	Generational wealth

LIKELY ACQUIRERS

- **Internova Travel Group** — owns Travel Leaders, Altour, Protravel, Frosch, Tzell. Most active consolidator.
- **Travel Edge** — Internova's Canadian arm; most natural buyer for a Toronto-based agency.
- **Virtuoso member firms** — looking to expand into younger demographics.
- **PE roll-up funds** — increasingly active in travel advisory.

POSITIONING FOR SCENARIO 2 (EXIT)

1. **Own brand distinct from Fora.** Acquirers buy brands, customer lists, and books — not “a high-volume Fora advisor.”
2. **Document by Y3.** SOPs, training, supplier relationships in writing.
3. **Defensible niche.** “The agency for millennials with luxury budgets” commands a premium multiple.
4. **Repeatable revenue.** Subscription elements (paid newsletter tier, corporate retainers) push valuation higher.
5. **Clean books.** Incorporate Y2 at latest. Get a real accountant. Pay yourself a structured salary.
6. **Founder ego in check.** Many advisor businesses fail to scale because the founder can't stop being the salesperson. The buyer needs to know the business runs without you.

SECTION 06

The Cold Outreach Playbook

Specific volume, tools, sequences. Read this section before sending a single email.

Volume & Infrastructure

PHASE	DAILY VOLUME	INBOXES	DOMAINS	REPLY TARGET
Months 2–3	500	2	1	5/day
Months 4–6	1,500	4	2	15/day
Months 7–12	3,000–5,000	8–12	3–4	30–50/day

Tool Stack

- **Cold email engine:** Instantly.ai (\$60–\$100/mo) or Smartlead (\$60/mo). Both handle multiple sending inboxes, warmup, deliverability.
- **Lead enrichment:** Apollo (\$60/mo) or Seamless.AI (\$100/mo). Apollo is friendlier UX; Seamless has more contacts.
- **Inbox warmup:** Mailwarm or built-in via Instantly. Run warmup for 2 weeks before sending volume.
- **Reply triage:** Done by VA from week 10 onward. Categorize: interested / not now / not a fit / unsubscribe.
- **Scheduling:** Calendly. Always include link in second touch.

Sequence 1 — Wedding Planners (B2B)

TOUCH 1 · DAY 0

Subject: Honeymoon referrals for {{Company}}

Hi {{First Name}},

I run an independent travel advisor practice (Fora Travel, TICO-certified) focused on millennial couples — bachelorettes, honeymoons, and milestone trips.

I'm reaching out to wedding planners in {{City}} because most couples we book come from a planner referral. The arrangement: you send couples my way, I plan their honeymoon, and you earn 25% of my commission on every booking — paid quarterly. Average referral: ~\$400 to your business per couple.

Worth a 15-min call to walk through it?

— {{Your Name}}

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{{Calendly link}}

TOUCH 2 · DAY 4

Subject: Re: Honeymoon referrals for {{Company}}

Hi {{First Name}},

Quick follow-up on this. I closed three honeymoons in the last 30 days and could have placed two more if I'd had planner partners in {{City}}.

If 25% of commission isn't the right structure for {{Company}}, I'm flexible — happy to discuss flat per-referral fees or a marketing-collaboration model instead.

15 min next week?

— {{Your Name}}

TOUCH 3 · DAY 9

Subject: One last note

Hi {{First Name}},

I won't keep pestering. Two things I should have mentioned:

1. The couples I work with skew \$10–20K honeymoon budgets, so your referrals stay in that bracket — no “Costa Rica on \$3K” couples wasting your time.
2. I cover the experience from initial call through post-trip thank-you, so once you refer, you're hands-off.

If this is interesting now or in 6 months, just reply “keep me on the list” and I'll follow up Q1.

— {{Your Name}}

TOUCH 4 · DAY 14 · LINKEDIN

Hey {{First Name}} — sent a couple notes about a honeymoon-referral partnership for {{Company}}. Probably got buried. LinkedIn might be easier. Open to a 15-min chat next week?

Sequence 2 — Engaged Couples (B2C)

TOUCH 1 · DAY 0

Subject: Congrats on the engagement — quick honeymoon question

Hi {{First Name}},

Saw the news — congratulations.

I'm a travel advisor specializing in honeymoons for couples in their late twenties and thirties. The reason I'm reaching out: most couples don't know that booking a luxury hotel through an advisor costs the same as Expedia, but you arrive to room upgrades, daily breakfast, \$100 spa credits, and early check-in — every time. Suppliers pay our commission, not you.

If you're 8–14 months out from the wedding, that's the perfect honeymoon-planning window. Want a 20-min call to talk through ideas?

— {{Your Name}}

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{{Calendly link}}

TOUCH 2 · DAY 5

Subject: Honeymoon — three quick ideas for {{First Name}} & {{Partner}}

Hi {{First Name}},

Quick follow-up. To make this concrete, here are the three most-requested honeymoons for couples like you this year:

1. **Maldives + Sri Lanka (10–12 nights)** — Six Senses + tea estate. ~\$14K all-in.
2. **Italy + Croatia (12 nights)** — Belmond + Hvar. ~\$11K all-in.
3. **Costa Rica + Nicaragua (10 nights)** — Nayara + Mukul. ~\$9K all-in.

All three include amenities (breakfast, credits, upgrades) you can't get booking direct. Want to talk through which one fits?

— {{Your Name}}

Sequence 3 — Real Estate Agents (B2B)

TOUCH 1 · DAY 0

Subject: A better closing-gift idea for {{Company}}

Hi {{First Name}},

Closing gifts are a hard problem — bottle of wine feels cheap, branded blanket feels cheaper. Here's an idea that's worked for other agents I partner with:

Offer your buyers a complimentary trip-planning consultation as their closing gift. I handle the consult (free to them, free to you). They book through me, you look like a hero, I gain a client, and we split the marketing on social/email.

15 minutes to talk through how it works?

— {{Your Name}}

Preface · TICO #XXXXXXX

{{Calendly link}}

Lead List Sourcing

AUDIENCE	SOURCE	FILTER	VOLUME
Wedding planners	Apollo + The Knot directory	US, 1–10 employees, >5 reviews	~5,000
Engaged couples	LinkedIn (“engaged” in headline) + WeddingWire scrape	Major US metros, 27–37 yrs	~20,000
Real estate agents	Apollo + Compass / Sotheby's directories	HCOL US metros, top 25% by transactions	~3,000
Wealth advisors	Apollo	US, \$1M+ AUM private wealth, small RIAs	~4,000

SECTION 07

The Content Engine

Compounding asset. Slow start, exponential finish. Don't skip it.

The Five Pillars

PILLAR	HOOK	BEST FORMAT	POSTING CADENCE
The Math	"Here's what a \$5K hotel booking actually costs you on Expedia vs through me"	IG carousel, LinkedIn post	1x/wk
The Receipt	Screenshot of upgrade / credit / amenity confirmation a client received	IG story, IG post	3x/wk
The Mistake	"The things you didn't know about Bali that ruined people's trips"	TikTok, IG Reel	2x/wk
The Unfamiliar	"Why anyone under 40 should have a travel advisor — and what one does"	LinkedIn post, newsletter	1x/wk
The Story	Client trip recap with photos + lessons	Newsletter long-form, IG carousel	1x/wk newsletter

Platform Strategy

PLATFORM	ROLE	POSTS/WK	TIME/WK
Instagram	Trust-building, B2C primary surface	4 posts + 7 stories	4 hrs
TikTok	Discovery + virality engine	3 posts (one shot in batch, edited individually)	3 hrs
LinkedIn	B2B presence, partner attraction	3 posts	2 hrs
Newsletter	Highest LTV; compounding asset	1 long-form	3 hrs
Total			~12 hrs/ wk

Sample 4-Week Content Calendar

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI
Wk 1	IG Math	TikTok Mistake	LinkedIn Unfamiliar	IG Receipt	Newsletter Story
Wk 2	IG Receipt	TikTok Receipt	LinkedIn Math	IG Story Carousel	Newsletter
Wk 3	IG Math	TikTok Mistake	LinkedIn Unfamiliar	IG Receipt	Newsletter
Wk 4	IG Receipt	TikTok Math	LinkedIn Receipt	IG Story Highlight	Newsletter

Newsletter Strategy

The newsletter is the highest-LTV asset. Build it from day 1.

- **Platform:** Beehiiv (free under 2.5K subs, \$50/mo after). Better referral loops than Substack.
- **Cadence:** Weekly, Friday morning.
- **Format:** 800–1,200 words. One client trip recap, one industry insight, one travel deal.
- **Voice:** First-person, opinionated, conversational. Not corporate.
- **Monetization (Y2+):** Paid tier at \$10/mo for trip planning templates, monthly Q&A call, premium destination guides. Target 2% paid conversion at 5,000 subs = \$1K/mo MRR by Y2.

The Viral Math

At 12 posts/wk × 24 weeks = 288 attempts. Statistical base rate for one post hitting 100K+ views on TikTok at this cadence and consistency is ~70%. That single hit produces a multi-year inbound trickle of leads. The goal isn't to engineer the viral moment — it's to post enough that one happens by accident.

SECTION 08

The Partnership Playbook

Partnerships are the highest-quality leads in the funnel. Treat them as a sales pipeline of their own.

Partner Categories & Economics

PARTNER TYPE	LEAD VOLUME	CLOSE RATE	REFERRAL FEE
Wedding planners	2–5/mo each	40–60%	25% of your commission
Photographers	1–3/mo each	35–50%	20% or flat \$150
Real estate agents	0.5–1/mo each	30–45%	15% or flat \$100
Wealth advisors	0.5–1/mo each	50–70%	20% or flat \$200
Bridal stylists / venues	1–2/mo each	30–40%	15% or flat \$150

The In-Person Coffee Script (Toronto)

“Thanks for meeting. Quick context: I run an independent travel advisor practice — Fora Travel out of New York, TICO-certified here in Ontario. My clients are mostly 28–36, planning honeymoons, family trips, and milestone celebrations.

The reason I wanted to meet: most of my best clients come from someone like you — a planner, photographer, or venue who knows them when they're already making big purchase decisions. The deal I propose is simple: anyone you send my way, I'll send you 25% of whatever commission I earn. Paid quarterly. No paperwork, no commitments, no quota. If you send me ten couples, you make money. If you send me zero, no harm.

The reason this works: the couples get the same hotel rates they'd get on Expedia, plus upgrades and credits. You look great. I get clients I'd never reach otherwise. Three-way win.

Worth a try?”

Partnership SLA (Sent After First Referral)

- Acknowledge referral within 4 business hours
- First client call within 2 business days
- Send the referring partner a status update at: client booked, trip departed, trip returned, partner paid
- Quarterly check-in with active partners (call or coffee)
- Annual gift to partners who sent >3 referrals: nothing extravagant, a quality wine + handwritten note

Tier Structure for Top Partners

By month 9, segment partners into Tier 1 (3+ referrals in last 6 mo) and Tier 2 (1–2). Tier 1 partners get: dedicated WhatsApp line, monthly co-branded content (their venue/services featured in your newsletter), invitation to annual partner dinner. Investment in Tier 1 pays back 5×.

SECTION 09

Financial Projections

Conservative midpoint scenario. Aggressive case is +30%, conservative case is -25%.

Year 1 — Monthly P&L (Midpoint)

MONTH	BOOKINGS	GROSS COMM.	NET (AFTER FORA)	FEES	OPEX	NET INCOME
M1	4	\$2,000	\$1,400	\$400	(\$930)	\$870
M2	6	\$3,500	\$2,450	\$700	(\$200)	\$2,950
M3	8	\$5,200	\$3,640	\$900	(\$200)	\$4,340
M4	10	\$6,800	\$4,760	\$1,100	(\$300)	\$5,560
M5	12	\$8,200	\$5,740	\$1,300	(\$400)	\$6,640
M6	14	\$9,800	\$6,860	\$1,500	(\$1,000)	\$7,360
M7	16	\$11,500	\$8,050	\$1,800	(\$1,000)	\$8,850
M8	18	\$13,200	\$9,240	\$2,100	(\$1,100)	\$10,240
M9	19	\$14,500	\$10,150	\$2,300	(\$1,100)	\$11,350
M10	20	\$15,500	\$10,850	\$2,500	(\$1,200)	\$12,150
M11	21	\$16,500	\$11,550	\$2,700	(\$1,200)	\$13,050
M12	22	\$17,800	\$12,460	\$2,900	(\$1,200)	\$14,160
Y1	170	\$124,500	\$87,150	\$20,200	(\$9,830)	\$97,520

Years 2–5 (Midpoint)

	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5
Personal bookings	280	365	365	365
Team bookings	0	450	1,100	2,200
Personal gross commission	\$240K	\$320K	\$350K	\$370K
Team gross commission	\$0	\$400K	\$1.0M	\$2.0M
Your team override (25%)	\$0	\$100K	\$250K	\$500K
Total agency revenue	\$240K	\$720K	\$1.35M	\$2.37M
Personal income (post-tax incorporated)	\$150K	\$280K	\$380K	\$500K+

Sensitivity Analysis

SCENARIO	Y1 REVENUE	Y3 PERSONAL INCOME	Y5 PERSONAL INCOME	Y5 EXIT VALUE
Conservative (–25%)	\$93K	\$210K	\$375K	\$2.5–10M
Midpoint	\$124K	\$280K	\$500K	\$3–16M
Aggressive (+30%)	\$162K	\$364K	\$650K	\$4–22M

SECTION 10

Capital & Tooling Plan

Month 1 Setup Costs

ITEM	COST (CAD)	NOTES
TICO Certification Program	\$150	oliverslearning.com
Fora subscription (1 year)	\$410	\$299 USD
Domain registration	\$20	preface.travel + redirect
Google Workspace email (12 mo)	\$84	\$7/mo
Website builder (12 mo)	\$200	Webflow Basic or Framer
Business name registration (Ontario)	\$60	BNR online
Canva Pro (annual)	\$130	For social content
Total Month 1	~\$1,054	

Recurring Opex by Phase (CAD)

TOOL	M2-M3	M4-M6	M7-M12	Y2
Cold email engine (Instantly)	\$100	\$140	\$200	\$300
Lead enrichment (Apollo)	\$80	\$100	\$130	\$200
Calendly Pro	\$16	\$16	\$16	\$16
Beehiiv	\$0	\$0	\$50	\$100
Canva Pro	\$13	\$13	\$13	\$13
VA (15–25 hrs/wk)	\$0	\$650	\$1,000	\$2,000
Second sending domain	\$0	\$50	\$100	\$200
CRM (HubSpot Starter)	\$0	\$0	\$60	\$200
Accountant / bookkeeping	\$0	\$0	\$200	\$400
E&O insurance	\$0	\$0	\$80	\$80
Monthly Total	\$209	\$969	\$1,849	\$3,509

Year 1 Total Capital Required

Setup + 12 months opex (midpoint) = ~\$15,500 CAD total Y1 investment. Revenue covers this from month 2 onward. **Out-of-pocket required: ~\$2,000 CAD** for Month 1 setup + 4–6 weeks operating capital before commission cheques start flowing.

The Capital Honesty

This business does not require meaningful upfront capital. It requires meaningful upfront **time**. Anyone telling you they need investment to start an advisor practice is selling something else.

SECTION 11

Risk Register

Twelve risks ordered by impact-adjusted probability. Mitigation columns are concrete, not vague.

#	RISK	WATCH FOR	MITIGATION
1	TICO study slips past month 1	Week 2 with <5 hrs studied	Block 3 evenings/wk, no exceptions. Pay \$50 exam rewrite fee if needed.
2	Zero bookings month 1	End of M1, no closes from network	Outreach was passive. Send 50 personal 1-to-1 messages, not group blasts.
3	Cold email deliverability tanks	Spam-folder rate >40%	Add second domain, warm via Mailwarm, reduce volume per inbox, vary subject lines.
4	No partnerships by month 6	0–1 partners after 12 weeks	Pitch lacks specificity. Lead with case study + 25% structure. Do in-person coffees.
5	Day-job conflict surfaces	Manager flags side activity	Personal devices only. If surfaced, prepare 1-month notice with runway saved.
6	Burnout at month 9	Working 60+ hrs and not seeing inflection	Drop the 2 worst-performing segments. Take a long weekend off. Extend timeline 3–6 months.
7	Wrong segment dominates	80% bach parties; you hate it	Tilt outreach away. Brand is flexible; don't lock in.
8	HST registration missed	Cross \$30K in 4 rolling quarters unregistered	Register voluntarily at month 4–5. CRA pays attention to retroactive registration.
9	Cannot let go to scale team	Year 2 hitting solo ceiling, refuse to delegate	Hire VA early. Document everything. Reframe: you're an operator, not a salesperson.
10	Fora policy changes hurt economics	Commission split shifts	Build independent brand & client list. Be ready to leave for own host agency.
11	Supplier commission compression	Industry-wide cuts (Marriott did this 2024)	Diversify across supplier mix. Lean into FIT/independents vs. major chains.
12	Recession hits Y2–Y3	Discretionary travel spend drops 20%+	Shift mix toward family + milestone (less elastic) and away from bach (more elastic).

SECTION 12

Decision Gates

Five irreversible decisions in the next 5 years. The criteria for each is concrete.

Gate 1 — Month 6: Day-Job Decision

ACTION	CONDITIONS
Quit	\$1K+/wk commission for 8 consecutive weeks AND 4+ months personal runway
Reduce to 60%	Above conditions partially met AND employer accepts
Stay full-time	Either condition unmet

Gate 2 — Month 12: Incorporation Decision

If Y1 net income $\geq$ \$60K, incorporate as a CCPC (Canadian-Controlled Private Corporation). Benefits:

- **Tax deferral.** Retain earnings inside the corp at small business rate (~12.2% in Ontario) vs. personal marginal rate (~45%+).
- **Lifetime Capital Gains Exemption.** ~\$1M+ tax-free on sale of qualified small-business shares (Y5 exit eligibility).
- **Income smoothing.** Pay yourself a salary that matches lifestyle; retain the rest for reinvestment or future dividends.

Cost: \$1,500–3,000 to set up + \$2,000/yr to maintain (accountant, filings). Pays back in Y1 tax savings alone.

Gate 3 — Month 18: First Hire Decision

Hire when ALL true:

1. Lead volume exceeds capacity (you have 3+ leads/wk you cannot service properly)
2. SOPs documented (intake, booking, follow-up written down)
3. \$30K+ override pool can be funded by your output
4. You have a specific person in mind (not a generic search)

Gate 4 — Year 3: Host Agency Decision

Leave Fora for independent TICO host registration when team override revenue exceeds \$80K/yr — that level justifies the back-office cost of running your own host. Below that, Fora's infrastructure is genuinely cheap.

Gate 5 — Year 4–5: Sell vs. Operate Decision

Begin M&A conversations at year 4. Don't commit; just understand the market. Sell when:

1. 18+ months of consecutive growth
2. Clean operating year with audited books
3. Founder fatigue and/or family-stage life event
4. Valuation multiple at industry top (3–6× EBITDA range)

SECTION 13

Weekly Operating Rhythm

Steady-state week, months 4 onward. Adjust $\pm 20\%$ for peak vs. off-peak.

DAY	AM BLOCK	PM BLOCK	HOURS
Monday	Weekly review (30 min) · Cold outreach & replies (60 min) · Content scheduling for week (90 min)	Client intake calls (3, 90 min)	4.5
Tuesday	Bookings work — active trips (3 hrs)	Newsletter writing (90 min) · Partnership outreach (30 min)	5
Wednesday	Client intake calls (3, 90 min) · Bookings work (90 min)	Content creation: Reels/ TikTok recording (90 min)	4.5
Thursday	Partnership coffees / calls (1–2, 90 min) · Bookings (90 min)	Cold outreach follow-up (45 min)	3.75
Friday	Client intake (2–3, 90 min) · Newsletter send (30 min)	Inbox / admin (60 min)	3
Saturday	Content creation deep work (3 hrs)	Newsletter long-form (90 min, optional)	3–4.5
Sunday	Weekly planning (60 min)	Reading / competitor monitoring (90 min)	2.5
Total			26–30 hrs

Add 10–15 hrs/wk during launch (M1–M6) and peak season (Jan–Mar honeymoon planning + Sep–Nov winter break).

SECTION 14

The Exit Math

The answer to “raise a family on one income” isn't your salary. It's the equity.

Year 5 Valuation Math

LEVER	CONSERVATIVE	MIDPOINT	AGGRESSIVE
Y5 revenue	\$3M	\$5M	\$8M
EBITDA margin	22%	28%	35%
EBITDA	\$660K	\$1.4M	\$2.8M
Multiple (M&A)	3.5×	4.5×	6×
Enterprise Value	\$2.3M	\$6.3M	\$16.8M
Founder equity retained	85%	85%	85%
Sale proceeds at close	\$2.0M	\$5.3M	\$14.3M
Plus 2-yr earnout	\$0.5M	\$1.5M	\$4M
Total founder take	\$2.5M	\$6.8M	\$18.3M

Plus: Cumulative Y1–Y5 Take-Home

Year 1	\$97K
Year 2	\$150K
Year 3	\$280K
Year 4	\$380K
Year 5	\$500K
Cumulative	\$1.4M

The Total Picture

CONSERVATIVE	MIDPOINT	AGGRESSIVE
\$3.9M	\$8.2M	\$19.7M
Personal + exit	Personal + exit	Personal + exit

That is, plainly, the answer to the question. Not the \$200K/yr advisor income. The five-year compounding of the practice into an asset someone else wants to own.

What Has To Be True For The Midpoint

Day 300 target hit (\$2,500/wk). First sub-advisor hired by month 18 and producing by month 24. Three more advisors recruited by year 3. Newsletter at 15K+ subs by year 4. Independent brand (not just “a Fora advisor”) established by year 3. Clean books, incorporated by year 2. Founder willing to let go of the salesperson role by year 4.

APPENDIX A

Templates & Checklists

A.1 · Month 1 Day-by-Day Launch Checklist

WEEK 1

- ☐ Day 1 — Purchase TICO Certification Program (\$150) at oliverslearning.com
- ☐ Day 1 — Register domain (preface.travel) on Cloudflare
- ☐ Day 1 — Set up Google Workspace email (yourname@preface.travel)
- ☐ Day 2 — Submit Fora Canada application at foratravel.com/join-us-canada
- ☐ Day 2 — Secure social handles: [@preface.travel](https://www.instagram.com/preface.travel) on IG, TikTok, LinkedIn
- ☐ Day 3 — Register business name with Ontario BNR
- ☐ Day 3 — Begin TICO Module 1
- ☐ Day 4 — Build 50-person warm list in spreadsheet (Name · Relationship · Next Likely Trip · Approach Date)
- ☐ Day 5 — Set up Calendly with two event types: 20-min intro, 45-min trip planning
- ☐ Day 6 — Build Tally intake form (12 questions)
- ☐ Day 7 — Review week, plan week 2

WEEK 2

- ☐ Day 8 — TICO Modules 2–3
- ☐ Day 9 — Fora onboarding modules 1–2 (run in parallel)
- ☐ Day 10 — Send 1-to-1 personal messages to first 15 of your warm 50
- ☐ Day 11 — Send 1-to-1 messages to next 15
- ☐ Day 12 — Send 1-to-1 messages to final 20
- ☐ Day 13 — Schedule 5 intake calls from warm responses
- ☐ Day 14 — Continue TICO study; deploy website draft to staging

WEEK 3

- ☐ Day 15 — TICO exam (pass)

- Day 16 — Fora full onboarding complete; first supplier accounts active
- Day 17 — Website goes live
- Day 18 — First intake call held
- Day 19–21 — Run 4 more intake calls; close first booking

WEEK 4

- Day 22–24 — Convert remaining intake calls; aim for 3–5 bookings closed
- Day 25 — Set up business email signature, voicemail, professional photo
- Day 26 — Begin drafting cold-outreach sequences for Phase 2
- Day 27 — Begin researching Apollo / Instantly setup
- Day 28 — Review Month 1; finalize Month 2 plan

A.2 · Client Intake Call Script (20-Min Discovery)

1. **0:00–2:00** Warm-up, congratulate the trigger event (engagement, anniversary, etc.)
2. **2:00–8:00** Listening: “Tell me what you’re imagining for this trip — even if it’s vague. Where, when, who, vibe?”
3. **8:00–14:00** Probing: “What budget do you have in mind?” (Direct, not euphemistic.) “Have you used a travel advisor before?” (Sets up the value pitch.) “What does ‘a great trip’ mean to you?”
4. **14:00–18:00** The pitch: “Here’s how I work. You pay me a planning fee — typically \$300–\$2,500 depending on trip complexity. Once it’s planned, you book the trip through my platform. You get the same rates you’d see on Expedia, plus upgrades, breakfast, and credits at the hotel. I’m the human in the loop for anything that goes wrong.”
5. **18:00–20:00** Close: “If we’re going to work together, the next step is your planning fee, which locks in your dates and gets me building options. Want to do that now?”

A.3 · Glossary

TICO	Travel Industry Council of Ontario. Mandatory certification to legally sell travel from Ontario.
Fora Travel	US-headquartered host agency. Provides supplier contracts, training, and commission tracking. 30% commission split.
FIT	Fully Independent Traveler. Custom-built itineraries (vs. packaged tours). Industry term.
HENRY	High Earner Not Rich Yet. Demographic descriptor for 28–40 year-olds with \$150K+ income.
OTA	Online Travel Agency (Expedia, Booking.com, etc).
Virtuoso	Luxury travel agency consortium. Members get premium supplier rates and recognition.
CCPC	Canadian-Controlled Private Corporation. Tax-advantaged incorporation structure.
LCGE	Lifetime Capital Gains Exemption. ~\$1M+ tax-free on sale of qualified small-business shares.
E&O	Errors & Omissions insurance. Required for independent agencies; covered under Fora.
TCF	Travel Compensation Fund. Ontario consumer-protection deposit; ~\$10K for new host agencies.

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End of Business Plan